People were often too lazy to go to a bank and deposit money physically as nationalized banks (especially for PPF accounts) did not have on line transaction facilities. However, now it is possible to successfully deposit money in a PPF account using online banking. So it is not difficult to invest the full quota of ₹1,50,000 per annum in a PPF account from the comfort of your home.

If you happen to be a salaried individual, something similar to PPF is already at work for you by the name of Employee Provident Fund[49] (EPF), though it does not take away the worthiness of PPF. Let us understand more about EPF now.

Financial Investment Tools	
Bank Fixed Deposits (FDs)	Superannuation
Bank Recurring Deposits (RDs)	Gold
PPF (Public Provident Fund)	Stocks
EPF (Employee Provident Fund)	Bonds
VPF (Voluntary Provident Fund)	Mutual Funds
National Pension Scheme (NPS)	FMPs (Fixed Maturity Plans) of MFs
Sukanya Samridhi Scheme (SSS)	Commodities
Gratuity	Real Estate

EPF (Employee Provident Fund)

I am sure you feel disgruntled when you look at your salary slip and find that sundry deductions have pared it down. But believe me, you should actually feel happy about one of these deductions- the monthly contribution to the Employees' Provident Fund (EPF), commonly called the Provident Fund (PF).

If you are salaried, there is no way you would not have heard of the Provident Fund (PF). In fact, there is no way that you would not have invested in it, because it is a compulsory investment for all salaried people (PF is compulsory if you work for a company having 20 or more employees). PF is a long-term investment, even longer term than PPF. It is